

he states that the 'King's Courts were remote and difficult of access.' Yet during much of this period the king's bench was moving from shire to shire, and the justices of the peace were sitting in many small villages; apart therefore from infrequent eyres, village folk were giving information to common law juries of presentment or were themselves acting as jurors. In other words, the 'isolationist' theory of the manor needs modification.

It is natural that the author of *The Pastons and their England* should regret the lack of letters, diaries, and inventories of peasants' goods. Fortunately, however, it can be shown that partial substitutes exist in records of cases of felony and trespass in royal courts. To cite a few examples: spirited colloquies, details about children, lists of goods stolen from village houses, thefts from churches of chalices, the Host, silver shoes from the statue of a saint. Scattered though such evidence is, it will go far to supplement Mr Bennett's material for his self-imposed task of lightening 'some dark corner of the medieval scene.'

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TH.-M. CHARLAND, O. P., *Artes Praedicandi: Contribution à l'histoire de la rhétorique au moyen âge* (Publications de l'Institut d'études médiévales d'Ottawa, VII). Paris-Ottawa, 1936. 420 pp. \$2.75.

FATHER CHARLAND has accomplished a large task, and surmounted difficulties that researchers in the field of mediaeval preaching can appreciate. His book represents an advance far forward in the cultivation of this new and rich field; henceforth students of the late Middle Ages and of the history of rhetoric will turn to it for the best exposition of the sermon-technique now available, and for the text it supplies of two treatises which were influential upon later theory and were for their period probably unsurpassed in excellence.

A pictorial *Arbor praedicandi* serves as frontispiece of the book, and Father M.-D. Chenu has written an excellent Introduction. The work proper is then divided into three parts.

Part I considers the authors and manuscripts. Charland lists a few newly ascertained authors and their tracts, and establishes new identifications in authorship. He succeeds in coalescing a goodly number of the items in my Hand-Lists of manuscripts, fixing the proper relationship, and subjoins valuable notices in many instances. He adds twenty-one manuscripts not included in my Hand-Lists. These additions can be supplemented with 1) Thomas of Salisbury's *De arte praedicandi*, Cambridge, Corpus Christi 445 (note: *saec.* XIII), fols. 1-89^v (Inc.: *Humanae naturae conditio secundum geminam sui*; see G. R. Owst, rev. of my Hand-Lists in *Medium Aevum*, VI, 2, Aug. 1937, p. 155); and 2) the *Ars sermocinandi* of Landolfo Caracciolo, Cracow, Univ. Jag. 1295 (see P. Amedeus a Zedelgem, rev. of my first Hand-List in *Collectanea Franciscana*, Apr. 15, 1937, p. 275). Mrs Damon Boynton, who intends to publish Alcock's treatise, also directs my attention to the edition of this work in Rome, *Vatican Incun. Stamp. Rossiano 718*, thought to be a copy perhaps of *Hain 8169*. A number of the manuscripts in my lists do not appear in Charland's; since his plan was to include only such tracts as he knew definitely to be technical, it is understandable that he has

omitted doubtful ones. Yet some of the items in my lists which he does not use may upon examination prove to be technical treatises. Several differences between Charland's data and my own, especially in the foliation of tracts, were bound to arise, but any one interested in editing the pertinent manuscripts can protect himself by consulting both Charland's lists and mine. I may add that *Lincoln 101* is in the Bodleian and might have been listed accordingly in the Table; that *Dresden B 105* appears as *A 105* in the Table; that to the Fusignano incunabula may be added *Hain 8161*, *8169*, and *8175* (see Ernst Voulliéme, *Der Buchdruck Kölns bis zum fünfzehnten Jahrhundert* [Bonn, 1903], pp. 232-235).

Part II is an exposition of the theory of Preaching and its Evolution, clear and detailed, which throughout evinces Charland's mastery of the theological intricacies as well as of the rhetorical features of the art. His exposition is based on two tracts, Robert Basevorn's *Forma Praedicandi* (written in 1322) and Thomas Waleys' (d. 1350) *De modo componendi sermones*.

An edition of these two tracts comprises Part III. Charland found that he had mainly to depend on *Bruges 228* for Basevorn's text, although making use of other manuscripts, and on *Cambridge Univ. Gg. vi. 20* for Waleys', although *Oxford, Bodleian 5* helped to fill lacunae and supplied variants worthy of note. I have never carefully examined the manuscripts of Basevorn, but a comparison of the Cambridge manuscript and *Bodleian 5* with Charland's text of Waleys at a number of places gives me complete confidence in the accuracy of Charland's transcription. He dispenses with a critical apparatus, but indicates possible variant readings in the footnotes. It is only in respect to this section of the book that one might suggest improvement. It would have been better editorial method to place precisely all the Biblical quotations, and of those citations other than Biblical which he has not traced, to indicate those which it was impossible to trace and those which were found to be wrong. I list several untraced references: p. 261 (Jacques de Vitry); p. 272 (quidam philosophus salanus); p. 292 (Boethius); p. 309 (Aristotle); p. 338 (Gregory). One misses also a special consideration of the sources used by Basevorn and Waleys. Even the citations in the footnotes suggest that further study would bring forth a varied and interesting list of classical and mediaeval works on which these theorists of preaching depended.

Father Charland chose to edit these two texts of the many he has painstakingly read in manuscript, and the choice does credit to his judgment. They both represent the theory of university preaching before the clergy, yet each has a marked individuality of its own. A feature of Basevorn is his contrast of the methods of Oxford and Paris. Waleys' emphasis is somewhat greater on the psychological aspects of preaching. Despite the artificiality of thematic preaching, the treatises abound in good sense and in striking observations. I append only a few of the points which a study of the rhetoric of these tractates will doubtless emphasize.

Basevorn makes *praedicatio* the counterpart of logic, as Aristotle considers rhetoric to be the *antistrophos* of dialectic; and further distinguishes the function of the *praedicator* from that of the *concionator* and of the *orator vel narrator qui est vir bonus, dicendi peritus*. His chapter 13 is a defense of *eloquentia*. For figures of speech he refers the preacher to the *Rhetorica ad Herennium*, book 4. At least

twice he cites Cicero, *De Inventione*, once (p. 305) miscalling it the *Rhetorica Secunda*. His discussion of the twenty-two kinds of *ornamenta* of the English sermon, and particularly of cadences, and the different kinds of *correspondentia*, and curiosities like his principle of division by means of the notes of the musical scale, which are to serve as mnemonic aids to indicate the beginnings of each verse, are especially noteworthy. These are matched by Waleys' comparison of the preacher's right to digress and the poet's license in metre and quantity, his narrative and argumentative methods of introduction, his precepts on how to quote Scripture, and his elaborate and lively treatment of rhythmical colors. Reproving excesses like *bilis* and *trilis*, and *osus* and *bosus*, he yet permits rhythm and rhyme in certain circumstances, and indicates how expedient it is to have a collection of words of the same termination ready to use at need. The preacher must not 'for the sake of rhythm use new words or words not in common use among the intelligent,' for that raises laughter, 'as I have on occasion learned by experience.' On delivery, too, Waleys is well worth reading. 'The new preacher, before exposing himself in public, should first betake himself to a secret place, away from the sight of men, where no mocker may be feared, and there exercise himself by speaking to the trees and stones.' He would have the preacher choose someone to give him a sign to stop when the sermon has already lasted a reasonable length of time. Waleys' long chapter on *dilatatio* is not the least effective part of his treatise. From his discussion of etymology as a principle in Expansion we learn that *benignus* = *quasi bene ignitus*, and *sanctum* = *sine terra* (i.e. *coelestis*), for Greek *agios* = *a* and *gios*. Both treatises reveal how overrefinement and mechanical artifice yet combine with an admirable adherence to good order.

At the end of the book is an Index of Proper Names, a Table of *Initia*, and an Inventory of the manuscripts.

Work on mediaeval preaching is well on its way. Charland's book will encourage the publication of some of the important tractates that still remain to be edited and studied. Obviously a great variety of method will be found within the pattern of the thematic scheme of the sermon. Then we shall have to study thoroughly the sermons that are so plentiful for this period and have until recently been so carelessly neglected, in order that we may learn to what extent practice accorded with theory.

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Sancti Caesarii episcopi Arelatensis opera omnia nunc primum in unum collecta. Volumen I: Sermones seu admonitiones, studio et diligentia D. Germani Morin, presbyteri et monachi O.S.B. Maredsous, 1937. Pp. cxv+1056. 160 Belgas.

THIS superb monument of scholarship, which is dedicated to His Holiness, Pope Pius XI, is the fruit of nearly half a century's devoted labor. Dom Morin has written innumerable articles on a wide variety of topics and he has edited not a few patristic texts, including some which had been thought lost and which he was the first to discover in this or that mediaeval manuscript. But he has never lost sight of his main goal through all these years, the publication of Caesarius' works